

The Pivot

From vanity to sanity. A strategic evolution, not a rebrand.

6 September 2026

PART 01

context.

What the numbers and the site visit actually say.

The overall plan is sound. Focus is the part that is missing.

01

The strategy is sound. The shape is not.

Comprehensive, and Justin's mental model that everything feeds refills is right. But it reads as AI theoretical. Too much equivalence, too many directions, and its own best insights are buried.

02

Two business units cancelling each other out.

Thought to be complementary, in reality pulling opposite ways. A good refill business takes traffic out of the Tap Room, which means more spend to replace it at a high cost per customer.

03

The weakest unit is getting the support.

Refills are at MVP, and only refills, and only beer. Marketing's time goes to propping up the unit that does not work, at the cost of the ones that do.

Three more, and the last one is the reason to move now.

04

The offer is good. The stars cannot shine.

We suspect a long tail of beer options is driving cost of goods. We also think it is causing choice paralysis at the point of sale.

05

Chasing two rabbits, catching neither.

For all the right reasons, marketing explores an idea, quits, and moves on. Nothing gets the run it needs to prove itself either way.

06

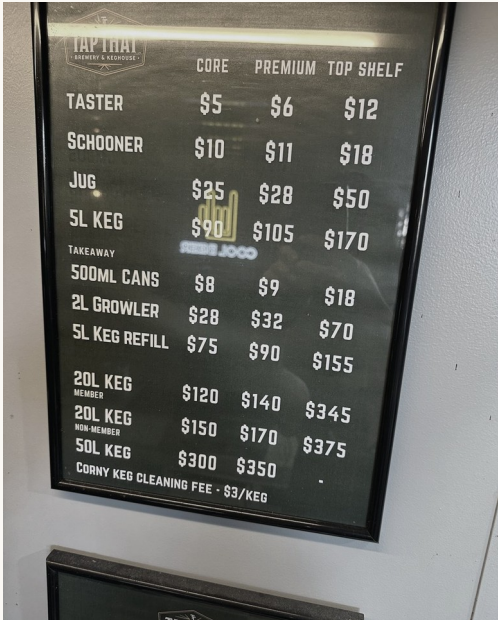
In danger of dying with a beautiful corpse.

Running a brewery is hard. Hospitality is harder. Both on a skeleton staff is unreasonable. Permission is needed to reshape the business.

The room the strategy has to work in.



27 taps, and a third of them are not beer



The price board, as it stands



The tour circuit already comes past



Referral rewards, already running

Tap Room is vanity. Refills are sanity.

96–113

Active refill customers, ordering repeatedly. That is MVP status, and it was reached without a push.

56%

of refill customers bought their tap system somewhere else. The refill proposition is already validated.

20%

of system buyers are said to have visited the Tap Room. That is correlation, not proven causation.

The Tap Room works as an event and function destination. It does not work as a walk-in, because the footfall is not there. The task now is to edit the losers hard and invest in what is proven.

Two things to hold on to before anything is decided.

Who is the real enemy?

Overpriced pubs. Not the duopoly, not A&A, not the keg delivery operators. Speak in unit economics everywhere, and do not get pulled into a keg price war you do not need to fight.

Handle the census with care

49 people, forced-choice answers. People do not always know, or say, why they buy. Status, wanting to be seen as successful, compensating for something else. Real drivers, rarely spoken. Useful colour. Not a strategy map.

PART 02

Direction.

Ten moves. Five of them come first.

Get the core right, then go for more.

MOVE	THE SHIFT	PROOF	FIRST STEPS
01 Tap Room: pause and pivot	Pause walk-in trading. Go all in on destination demand.	Event and function nights are already profitable.	PR to tourism, event and wedding planners. Own the tour circuit: Urban Legends booking tool, Pineapple Tours, the Crafted award. Ticketed events and collabs. Party rental, with minimum-guarantee kegs covering the rental cost.
02 Convert the owners already sold	Objections are already overcome for existing kegerator owners.	56% bought their system elsewhere.	Harvey Norman gift-with-purchase and point-of-sale tie-up, plus the buyer database. Buy Kegland and corny keg owner databases. Official Benchy partnership. Co-branded outdoor BBQ and system bundle.
03 Remove all friction in refills	Every extra step in the refill process costs a sale.	10% reorder monthly, 40% far later. One clock fails both.	Free delivery always works, and margin comes back in dollars, not percent. Replace the blanket 90-day SMS with consumption-triggered reminders. Lead on no CO2, pick up and go. Simplify membership. Get Justin off the bar and onto the road.
04 Rationalise the range	Create hero products that carry social proof, and cut the non-productive tail.	About 19 brew choices loses both curation and best-in-class.	Deeper product marketing on the brews that remain. Social proof cues such as most popular. Free the shelf space and the brewing time for the heroes.
05 Ride the wellness wave	Also the way back to lapsed customers.	40% of lapsed customers cite cutting back.	Low, non-alcoholic, low-carb and protein range. Wellness influencer collabs, amplify or co-develop. Reframe for the cutting-back cohort as a healthier alternative, not less beer.

Once the core is running, extend it.

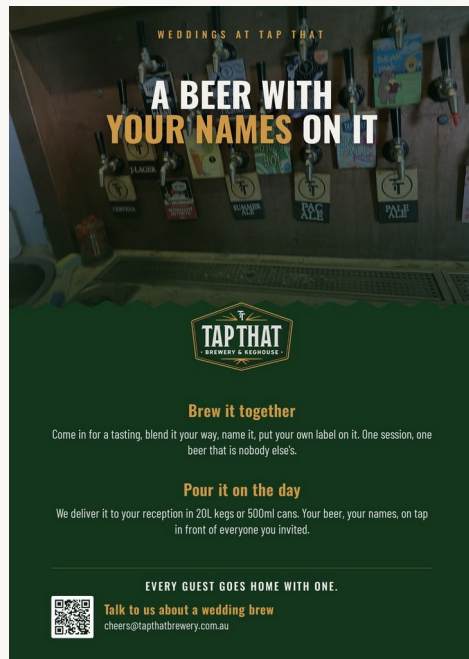
MOVE	THE SHIFT	PROOF	FIRST STEPS
06 Full press on wholesale	Resourced, structured and measured. No more falling through the cracks.	One wholesale account is worth about ten households.	Hire a full-timer or an agent. Set targets and KPIs. Custom systems for sporting clubs, with minimum-guarantee kegs per season. Move rigs from footy to cricket for year-round occupancy.
07 Design for her	Covered is not the same as catered for.	The interest in the brews is real. The range does not reflect it.	Romance the RTD properly. Build the hydration story through the wellness and light range. Products she is proud to serve. Systems designed to sit in eyesight at home.
08 Personalise comms and lifetime value	This needs a process, not a message.	Buying cycle: about 60% within three months, 40% longer.	Track consumption to predict the next refill. Re-engage lapsed customers by actual reason, cutting back versus forgot. Trigger-based outreach, not calendar-based. Personal details: anniversaries, footy finals.
09 Make the kegerator worth writing about	Turn the system itself into demand.	1,000 giveaway entries is proven demand.	User-generated content mechanic: tag Tap That, get a discount. Own your keg personalisation, like a whisky bottle. Explore short-term and occasion rental for parties.
10 Package around the duopoly	Locked-in venues still have real pain points.	Contractual lock-in is not the same as satisfaction.	A packaged offer that works around existing contracts. Find the judo move that uses their size against them: no lock-in, profit share, white labelling.

PART 03

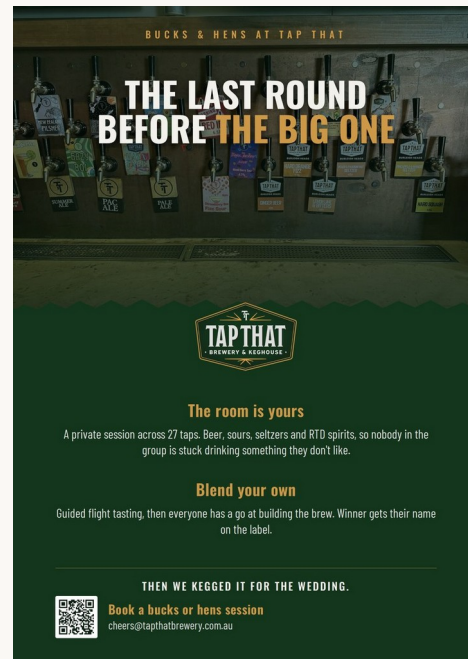
Collateral.

What the destination business looks like on paper.

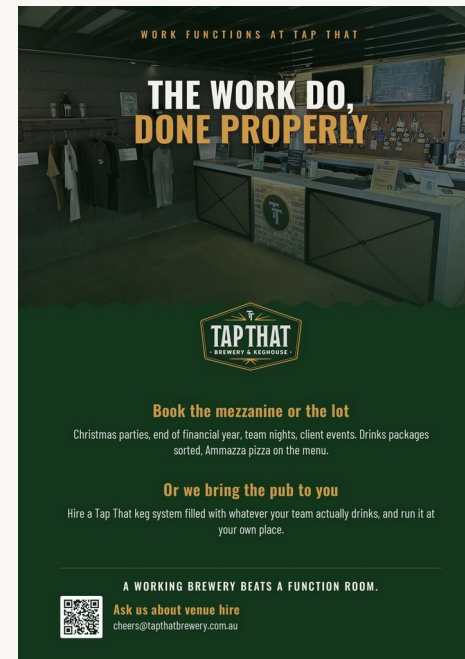
The destination business, sold the way the venue already sells it.



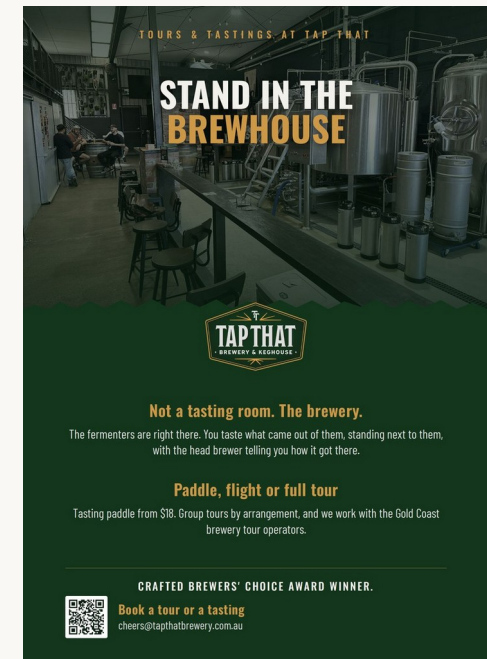
Weddings



Bucks and hens



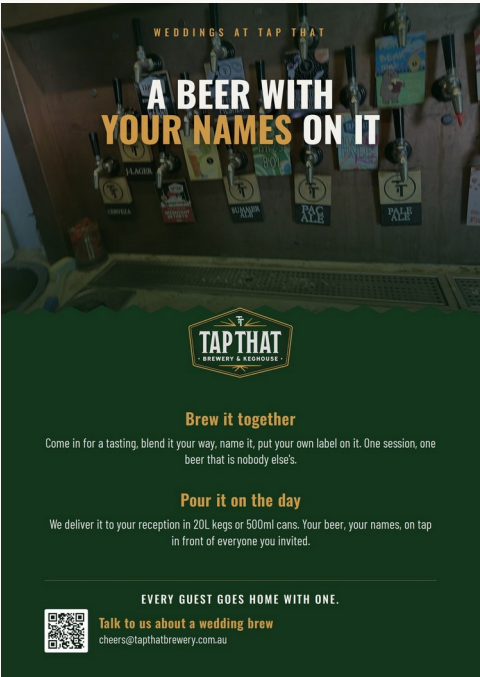
Work functions



Tours and tastings

Format taken from Tap That's own in-venue flyer. Photography is the August site visit, not stock. These sit in Tap That's brand, not ours, because they are the client's collateral. Print-ready A4 at 200 dpi.

Turning hens and bucks days into wedding day volume.



The artwork, ready to send

01 The Tap Room event

Private hens or bucks session. Guided flight tasting across 27 taps, with interactive ingredient blending.

02 Bespoke branding

Co-branded custom label, naming, and beverage style selection: beer, sour, seltzer or RTD spirit.

03 Wedding day reception

Bulk supply delivered in 20L kegs or custom cans for the main event.

04 Take-home compound

Every guest goes home with a branded sample and a QR code.

THE COMPOUND EFFECT

One private session captures premium venue hire upfront, secures pre-sold volume for the reception, and puts branded product into the hands of every guest.

What a co-branded system could look like.



Trade and worksite



Four-wheel drive and touring



Motorcycle clubs



Mobile bar for events

Concept renders for discussion. No approach has been made to any brand shown, and none of these marks are licensed. Worth showing for the reaction. Not for anything that leaves the room.

PART 04

**KEGGED
& READY**

**CRAFTING
SOON**

Execution.

The small fixes, and where we can help.

Small fixes, disproportionate impact.

Above the fold

No hook, background film cut too fast to read, copy pollution, low-resolution static logo.

Missing proof

The Crafted Brewers' Choice award, the fits-any-system callout and strong reviews are all buried below the fold.

Hierarchy

Four business units treated equally. Prioritise the moments that matter: family, friends, the proud provider role.

Category

Commercial brewer invites mainstream price and product comparisons. It needs an elevated category name of its own.

Channel language

Wholesale should speak directly to restaurants and sporting clubs. Cuisine matching, club-branded kegs, straight to the margin story.

What we can pick up from here.

FROM THE BRIEF

Website design optimisation

SEO and GEO best-practice implementation

PR outreach to tourism operators and experiential platforms

Influencer outreach

Partnerships outreach and project management

Urban Legends collaborative booking tool

ALSO WORTH ADDING

Trigger-based CRM and lifecycle build, which fixes the 90-day SMS problem

Membership programme redesign

Wholesale structure and KPI framework

Event flyer and campaign artwork, in the format shown

Next.

Wording finalised with Christy, then this deck goes to Justin.

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